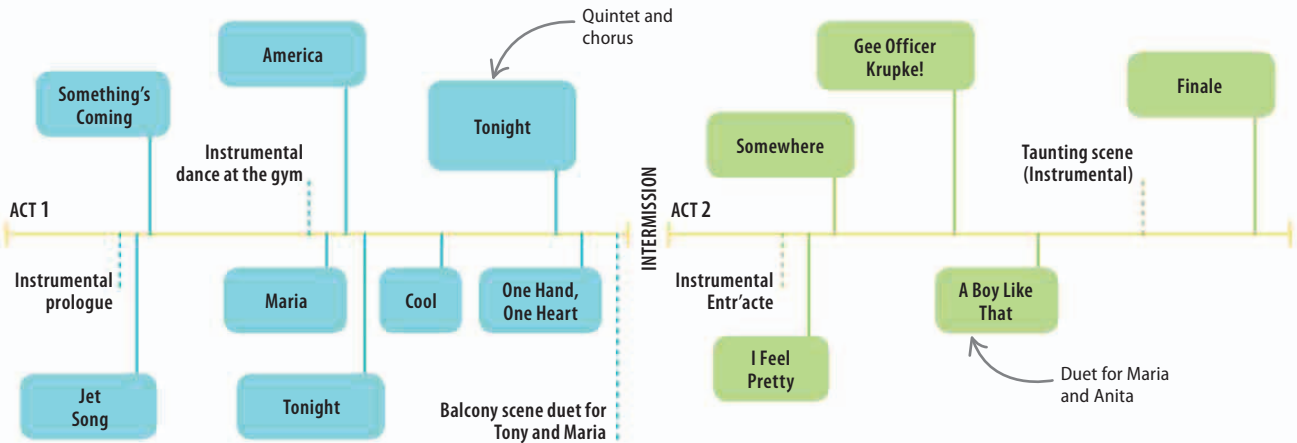


Musical theater

Musical theater combines catchy songs and choruses, dance, spoken dialogue, and instrumental interludes. Also known as “musicals,” these are often premiered and performed on New York’s Broadway or London’s West End. With simple but dramatic plots (stories), magnificent costumes, and spectacular sets, they have become a popular form of theatrical entertainment.

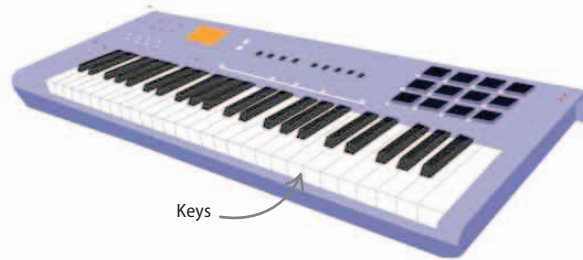
▽ *West Side Story*

Based on Shakespeare’s *Romeo and Juliet*, Leonard Bernstein’s 1957 musical, *West Side Story*, portrays the rivalry between two New York gangs, the Jets and Sharks, and the doomed love affair of Maria and Tony. The illustration below shows how the musical is structured.



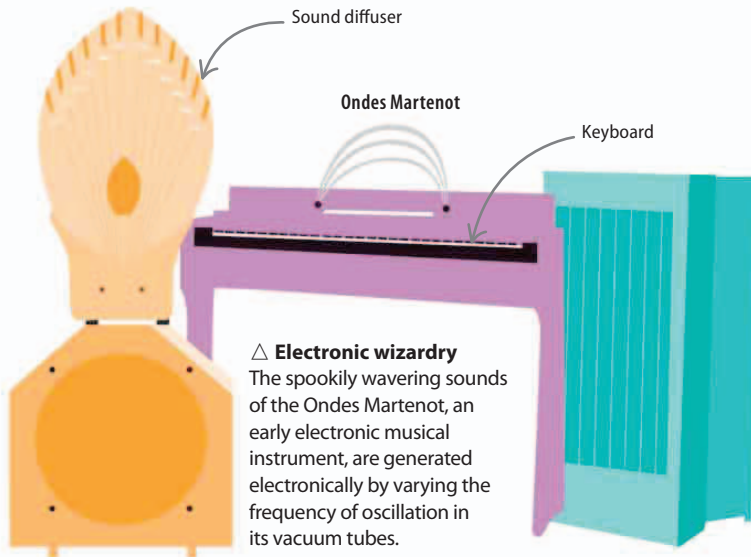
New age of technology

Though recording music began in the 19th century, recent developments in technology mean that classical music can be heard by anyone, anytime, and anywhere. Anyone can create and share their work. MIDI (Musical Instrument Digital Interface) allows devices to communicate with each other, sharing digital information for musical sounds.



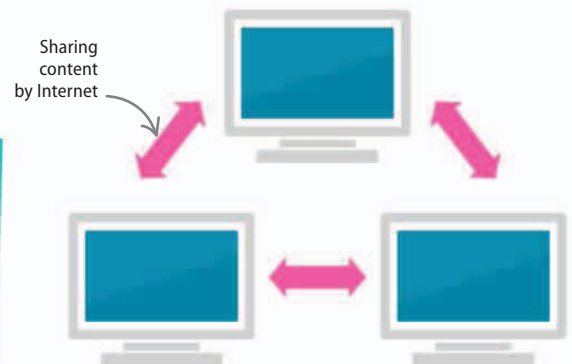
◁ MIDI controller keyboard

An important part of a composer's setup, keyboards such as this allow sounds to be generated and organized automatically, with mixes, delays, fades, filters, and cutoffs.



△ Electronic wizardry

The spookily wavering sounds of the Ondes Martenot, an early electronic musical instrument, are generated electronically by varying the frequency of oscillation in its vacuum tubes.



△ Web wonders

The internet connects computers and enables content to be moved from one computer to another. The worldwide web has transformed music by allowing content to be generated, contributed to, and shared.